ACTIVITY 063

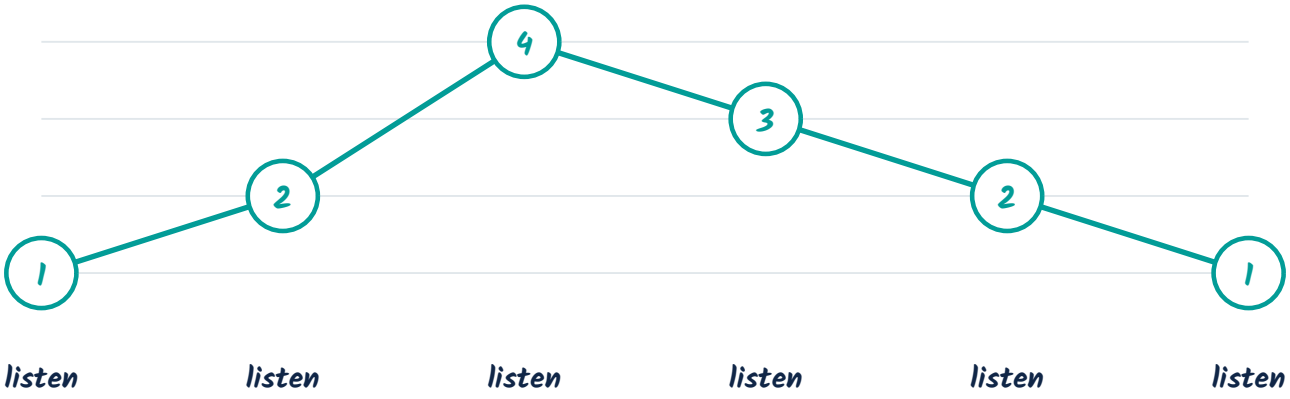
Melody Contour Map

Pitch & Listening

6 minutes / Paper and a short phrase.

Connect the shape of a melody to its sound.

Scale degrees in a comfortable key



Example contour: rise, turn, fall. Trace the model you actually hear.

1

Listen to a four- to six-note phrase without singing and trace its rise and fall with one hand.

2

Draw a simple line showing the direction changes; compare it with the model.

3

Sing the phrase while following the line, then look away and reproduce it once.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The drawn contour and sung direction agree at each turning point.

COMMON TRAP

Drawing a contour that disagrees with the model.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a two- or three-note contour and larger visual gestures.